

CS560 - UI/UX Design & Implementation

2-1 Short Paper: Exploring User Behavior

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LinkedIn UX Analysis: Empathy Map and User Journey

Asking questions regarding how the digital experience makes people interact with the website and perform tasks is vital. As a part of this course, I am a UX consultant who is supposed to analyze and identify the pain points on LinkedIn. I am using my experience of interacting with the platform to detect user needs, goals, frustrations, behavior patterns, and other aspects that could potentially be improved on LinkedIn.

Goals and Primary Task

My experience of browsing LinkedIn can be characterized by a few goals, including searching for a job, building connections, keeping myself aware of industry trends, and promoting my project, which is the TraffickAid app. Among all those goals, I chose searching for and applying to a job to analyze the user experience.

Empathy Map

While doing this job-related task on LinkedIn, I can describe my experience by saying what I say, what I think, what I do, and how I feel in terms of user interaction. Speaking about what I say, I frequently think of phrases like, "I hope I'll find something suitable for me" or "These job listings don't match my profile". Also, I may find a listing that looks interesting, but it requires some research before I apply. Thinking refers to doubts about whether this job posting is reliable and interesting to pursue. Besides, it can relate to questioning why my suggestions appear so irrelevant to my experience. However, sometimes I also think about whether my profile is strong enough for me to land any jobs. Concerning what I do, first, I use the search bar to find relevant positions based on keywords and apply filters to them. Afterward, I proceed to scroll along long

job listings and click the links that seem relevant and interesting to me. Finally, I can either save some positions or apply for jobs, depending on what I feel now. Also, I may update my LinkedIn profile. Regarding how I feel about this process, my feelings are quite mixed. There is some motivation because I can find an interesting job; however, it is frustrating because I am overwhelmed by all the listings. Sometimes, I feel annoyed because the filters are not working as expected. Lastly, I can feel uncertain about the result because there is no guarantee that I will get an offer.

User Journey: Applying for a Job

I can split the process of applying for a job into multiple steps. First, I open the app and log in to it. When I do that, I am presented with the home page feed, where I see various posts, updates, and advertising. Then, I navigate to the "Jobs" section to find relevant opportunities. I enter specific keywords to find them using the search tool. After entering keywords, I start applying filters related to such parameters as the location, experience level, and remote options. After this step, the job listings are updated in line with my choices. Then, I start scrolling through the job listings and reading them in more detail if needed. Once I found a job that interested me, I spent time analyzing this position and researching it thoroughly. I can also check the requirements, which are provided in the job listing. Finally, I either apply via the "Easy Apply" function or follow the link that redirects me to the job listing.

Pain Points

During this journey, I have met with multiple frustrations.

First, I had some trouble with irrelevant recommendations, especially since even after applying the filters, there were a lot of such positions. Second, information overload was one of the most

unpleasant moments when using this platform. There are too many jobs that appear and make you choose which one you are going to analyze next. Furthermore, the inconsistency of the application is also quite frustrating. Depending on how the employer organized this process, the user may need to switch to another site to apply for a certain position. Besides, I could not set my preferences precisely as needed because the degree of personalization was not high enough. Lastly, the differences between the mobile and desktop versions were disturbing since I felt a lack of certain details on mobile devices.

Opportunities for Improvement

To address these challenges, there are multiple suggestions I would like to mention.

For example, I believe that the level of personalization should be increased, and users could adjust more details in line with their preferences. In addition, I would suggest developing more advanced artificial intelligence-based algorithms for recommending jobs. Moreover, the interface of the platform should be simplified because of the presence of unnecessary elements. Also, LinkedIn should improve the consistency of applications because it is inconvenient to apply for jobs via different channels. It would also be helpful to add more detailed filters in terms of the position type, company culture, salary rate, company size, and other aspects. Lastly, I would recommend making the experience more accessible by changing the color contrast ratio and labels.

Conclusion

Overall, this case study showed that tools like the empathy map and user journey can be used to detect the weak points of a particular product.

References

Figma. (n.d.-a). *User journey map*. <https://www.figma.com/resource-library/user-journey-map/>

Figma. (n.d.-b). *Empathy map*. <https://www.figma.com/resource-library/empathy-map/>